

Saint Louis: What does our city need?

Put simply, we need people willing to invest in our downtown.

One fantastic example of folks who are willing to invest in our city are those who have funded the relatively recent project known as the *City Foundry STL*. You may simply know it as “The Foundry” Or the “mall across from IKEA”, but the City Foundry has well earned its full name.

Places like this in the city feel a little too unreal for comfort: It is a very pretty complex of old factory buildings, steel pipes, and bare machinery that has been revitalized from an old, abandoned industrial plot into a bustling mall you may very well have used for shopping, eating (at their *huge* food court, or seeing a movie at the theatre upstairs. Not only have malls like this on their own slowly gone extinct (across America, not just in STL), but their absence has lead to a huge decline in people visiting different areas of the city just to spend money and have fun.

According to one of the leading experts in the field of urban revitalization,

"The cityscape is very important to rebuild properly and beautifully, or else much of the city will go to waste under the ugly shadow of the new construction."

-John Urbanrevitalizationson

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